



BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY AND SCIENCE, Pilani
Pilani Campus
AUGS/ AGSR Division

FIRST SEMESTER 2026-27
COURSE HANDOUT

Date: 28.07.2026

In addition to part I (General Handout for all courses appended to the Time table) this portion gives further specific details regarding the course.

Course No : GSF213
Course Title : Development Theories
Instructor-in-Charge : Prof. Sailaja Nandigama

Instructor(s) : Agin K. Varghese (TA)

Tutorial/Practical Instructors: NA

1. Course Description: This course focuses on the concept of development, development theories and practices in the modern world. Interplay between theory and practice and the outcome of this relationship are also explored in the syllabus. The course provides an overview of development thinking from 'classical' development ideas to alternative and post development theories. The course then attempts to critically review contemporary debates about development, including the link between the current world order and the Development goals of the developing countries.

2. Scope and Objective of the Course: The objective of the course is to make the students aware of the debates and issues relating to development and post development. The course covers development theory and practice at the global and local levels and examines the practice in contemporary times.

. Text Books: John Rapley (2010), Understanding Development: Theory and Practice in the Third World Viva Books. (Reading material will be given by the IC through classroom portal)

4. Reference Books: Reports, journal papers, films and newspaper reports will be given in advance as preparation materials before lecture sessions.

5. Course Plan:

Module No.	Lecture Session	Reference	Learning outcomes
1	Introduction & onboarding (5)	General information & Discussion on Modern Political Ideologies	Students will get the necessary onboarding in several political ideologies as the course requires a good understanding of these political concepts and key theories on which development thinking rests
2	What is Development? Why study Development? (6)	TB Ch.1 (Partial)	Students will be exposed to the concept and practice of development through various historical examples
3	Development Theory in the Postwar Period (10)	TB Ch.2	Students will be able to learn about First, Second and Third



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			worlds, Keynes Thesis, the emergence of the third world, understanding Development after Keynes
4	State-Led Development in Practice (10)	TB Ch.3	Students will be able to learn about the Modernization theory; Import Substitution Industrialization, the postwar world economy, and Extreme Statist Experiments
5	Neo-classical Answer to Failure (10)	TB Ch.4	Students will be able to learn about the Neoclassical tradition, their analysis of Third World, The New Political Economy, and their recipe for Development

6. Evaluation Scheme:

Component	Duration	Weightage (%)	Date & Time	Nature of component (Close Book/ Open Book)
Mid-Semester Test	90 Min.	30	< 06/10 AN1 >	Close Book
Comprehensive Examination	3 h	40	<07/12 FN >	Close Book/ Open Book
*Class participation and attendance	70%	10%	NA	NA
Internal tests	40 minutes each	20%	Pre-announced	Close Book/Open Book

* This is applicable for students admitted after AY 2024-25.

7. Chamber Consultation Hour: Wednesday 11am. - 12 noon; **Class: M W F 8 (3 pm- 3.50 pm) in class room 6108.**

8. Notices: Shared on Classroom portal and through ERP.

9. Make-up Policy: Only genuine cases will get make-up opportunities in Mid-Sem and Comprehensive examinations, as determined by the IC. (Tests 1 and 2 will be announced in the class in advance and so, will not have make-up opportunities).

10. Attendance Policy: 70% attendance and above will be rewarded with 10% marks.

11. Minimum passing Marks criteria: 30% of the total marks must be obtained by each student to clear the course.

12. Note (if any): Course format will be interactive with regular class discussions and group exercises, documentary screening and presentations. Students are encouraged to attend classes and prepare in advance with the help of the reading material provided and through self-initiative as well.

Prof. Sailaja Nandigama
Instructor-in-charge
Course No. GS F 213